

Citadel Journal Issue 3

ROW, ROW, ROW YER BOAT!

Ships' Boats



Row, Row, Row Yer Boat!

By Andrew Thomas.

Messing about in dinghies and small boats in Man O' War (probably getting yourself blown to pieces in the process). Brought to you by the Journal on behalf of Andrew, who wrote in with the basic rules.

Small oared boats are available to all Man O' War Fleets. Some clever (or devious) admirals have even found a use for them in battle. They can be used as a lifeboat, a bomb-boat or as a raiding boat to carry small parties of well armed crew.

Boats can be bought for any ships in your Fleet, and cost 25 points each. Photocopy the boat counters at the bottom of the page and place appropriate ones on the relevant ship's template. A ship may carry as many boats as it has below the waterline hits. The boats of a ship do not have to be all of the same type.

GAME RULES

Launching Boats

A ship can launch boats after it has moved but before it has fired. Simply remove the boat counter from the template and place within 2" of the ship. The boats of a ship move the same time as the parent ship so it is a good idea to mark the counters below with the same symbol you use on the ship's template. Boats cannot move on the same turn they are launched and must be moved after the parent ship has performed any moving, firing and boarding for the turn. A boat may not be launched straight into contact with another ship and any actions such as Bomb-boats or boarding from Raiding boats will not be done until the next turn. Boats do not block line of sight for ship's or Sea Monsters.

For crewed boats such as the Raiding boat place the crew counters that are on board underneath the boat counter itself. A boat that can carry crew can also carry any characters such as Admirals and Wizards.

Bomb-Boats

These are set adrift from a ship, after the special triggers have been set on the large amounts of explosives that are packed into these unmanned vessels. Bomb-boats drift D6" in the direction of the prevailing wind. They are moved before any other craft, and the player with the initiative for the turn must move all of his Bomb-boats first.

Once a Bomb-boat comes into contact with a ship or Sea Monster it explodes (regardless of whose side the target belongs to). If it hits a sunken ship, wreckage or any other obstacle it explodes harmlessly, scattering the seascape with planking and nails.

If a ship set off the Bomb-boat it suffers one hit on a random Low location, re-rolling any misses. If you roll a one the fuses and triggers have failed, remove the Bomb-boat from the table. Any saving throws are made with a -1 save modifier, and may cause critical hits as usual. Monsters which suffer a hit will take a wound as normal.

Raiding Boats

Raiding Boats act as a very small ship. They only move by using oars, and can fire a small swivel-mounted cannon to the front of the vessel. This small cannon has a 180 degree fire arc to the front, like some Dwarf ships. It may only fire at short range and hits do not benefit from the normal -1 saving throw modifier for short ranged attacks. Raiding boats may move D3+1" per turn and move like a ship with oars, though they are manoeuvrable and use the Hawkship turning template when they change direction.

A Raiding boat may carry up to 2 crew counters, placed on the actual boat counter, which may board other ships as normal, and may also be boarded as normal, but note that the swivel gun cannot fire grapeshot.

Lifeboats

These large boats move and fight in the same way as Raiding boats, but may only carry one crew counter. They are also unarmed and so do not have the swivel gun. They may only be used when a ship is sunk. Note that the Characters may survive the sinking of the ship, but may not use a Lifeboat to escape death during a boarding action or when all the crew are killed in other circumstances. A Lifeboat is handy because an ordinary Raiding boat cannot be launched except during the ship's movement making it impossible to rescue crew in one.

Attacking Boats

Raiding boats and lifeboats may be boarded in the normal manner but may not be shot at by main weapons, as they cannot be pointed low enough to target small vessels bobbing just above the waves. A ship may use defensive fire (see p.17 of the Sea of Blood rulebook) to fire at boats within 3", and this is done after any other firing. Any dice that roll a 5 or more will hit the boat, causing it to make an unmodified save of 4+ or be destroyed. Destroyed boats do not create wreckage, so the occupants of a boat will be drowned automatically. Spells may be targeted at boats as usual, or at any crew they may have, and if the target takes any damage (after its 4+ save) it will be destroyed. Flyers and other boats may attack boats as normal, as can Sea Monsters. Unmanned boats, other than Bomb-boats, should be removed from play.

Raiding Boat	Raiding Boat	Raiding Boat	Raiding Boat
Lifeboat	Lifeboat	Bomb-boat	Bomb-boat